Grandpa Joe

A Eulogy

The Man We Knew as Joe

His name was Joseph Ellis. But almost nobody called him Joseph. To everyone, he was simply Joe. And to some of us gathered here today, he was Grandpa Joe.

There is something fitting about that. A short name, plain and easy to say, the kind of name you call out across a yard or over a fence.

Forty Years of Carpentry

Joe was a carpenter for forty years. Carpentry is patient work. It means measuring before you cut, and getting it right so that what you build will hold.

What Stays With Us

So the next time you climb the steps of one of those porches, take a moment to think of him. Rest a hand on the railing. Remember that someone took the time to build it well.

Thank you, Grandpa Joe. We will miss you.